

Fotonica

In a most wonderful succession of masterfully designed warp speed stages, the glowing vector lines and psychedelic neon waves that illuminate from the corners of your vision like some kind of excitement driven euphoria, Fotonica is unending runner perfection. When you achieve that zen-like state of attention, everything speeds up even more, the colours and motions get even more intense, creating a stunning audiovisual overload that sets it apart from the others.

You may start running on a linear course by pressing any button. When you release the button, you jump but do not accelerate, and when you push it again, you accelerate and go closer to the ground. The course selection is entirely bizarre. Some are made up of broken bits of railway track, while others are made up of living room furniture. There are large holes of nothing in between. You must retry the level if you fall. Levels aren't more than two minutes long. In the higher stages, you must learn when to leap short or long.

Arcade mode is divided into seven distinct levels, each with its own set of routes that ascend and descend. The aim isn't only to climb as high as possible in these levels; because the dots that may award extra points



are scattered around the level, finding the best pathways for dot collecting, as well as picking up and maintaining speed, is critical to climbing the leaderboards. On iPad, each arcade style level may be played in split-screen vs mode, with the first person to reach the end winning.

Endless mode is a complex case, with three distinct levels that at first appear uninteresting due to their absence of the multi-tiered architecture of the Arcade levels. But if you keep playing them, you'll realise what the difficulty is all about: repetition, not only making a leap from one height to another, but doing it twenty times at rapid rates. This game also teaches players how to handle specific circumstances, such as jumping from the middle of the ledge to reach the next platform instead of the end. It's intriguing since it employs the same ideas in a more straightforward manner for a new difficulty.

The controls, physics, and soundtrack all contribute to Fotonica's alien feel. Last but not least, there's a dizzying combination of frantic, furious electronica and spaced-out ambient rumblings. Fotonica always feels hypnotic, as if you're a robot going through its own fever dreams in a dazed stupor, a sensation that's amplified when you reach top speed, when the on-screen visuals turn golden and the audio muffled, as if the sound waves can't quite reach your ears.



My Hero Ultra Impact



Bandai Namco recently released My Hero Ultra Impact, a new gacha RPG. You're probably familiar with the gacha formula, especially if you're a regular gacha gamer. You summon characters from the show, assemble a squad, enhance

them, and then use them to defeat villains. A large part of the fight revolves around each character's unique powers, known as Quirks. The plot of the game allows you to experience scenes from the anime and manga, enhancing the narrative

Each episode is separated into stages, which might depict battles with evildoers or bosses, graphic novel-style discussion between characters, or comic-style cinematics. As the tale develops, the degree of difficulty grows, as do the prizes and the criteria to confront the fights. The fighting is turn-based and mainly automated, so you won't have to do anything besides tap once in a while to line up your fighters. Of course, as is the case with most gacha games in the market, there's also an auto option, which allows the game to run without the need for players to intervene.



The game is really very liberal with its rerolls, making it a lot more welcoming to free-to-play users than most other gachas, and nothing is hidden behind a paywall. Players will have to grind for resources, like with other gachas. Because there are no advertisements in the game, the gameplay experience is uninterrupted. While the game does include in-app purchases, the rerolls make it one of the greatest gacha systems available.

My Hero Ultra Impact is a good game, and it's one of Bandai Namco's finest, leveraging the IP in a very effective manner. It offers solid turn-based gameplay, a wonderful tale to follow, and most of the elements are in place. It doesn't really bring anything new to the table and may come off as a little bland to some, but it's still effective at what it does. Anyone who likes MHA and gacha games should give this game a go.

